course of events in the Assembly as an indication of the absence of that measure of general support for the Bill they thought they ought to have had behind them in carrying through so important a financial reform. In those circumstances they saw no justification for pressing the government view further upon the House. The further consideration of the Bill was, therefore, postponed *sine die*. Birkenhead who had confessed privately to the Viceroy Lord Irwin that in the absence of sufficient gold reserves a sterling loan would have to be floated before the bank could be started was not entirely displeased at the outcome. Blame was laid on the Legislature for its intransigence and the Viceroy solaced by interpreting the failure of the Bill as a political victory.

THE THIRD ROUND TABLE CONFERENCE

As we have noted before, the Viceroy announced a third and smaller Round Table Conference in September 1932 which Purshotamdas also attended. He was part of the delegation led by the Aga Khan appearing before the Joint Committee of both Houses of Parliament appointed to consider proposals on Indian constitutional reforms.

One of the important tasks of the Committee was to facilitate the drafting of the Reserve Bank Bill. Purshotamdas again had some dissenting observations to make in this connection. At the outset he observed that the Committee had not considered if India's economic and currency position justified a launching of the RBI within a year or two. The Committee had simply assumed that the RBI was to be set up and acted on this premise. One of the important issues Purshotamdas raised in his Minute of dissent to the Committee's report concerned the appointment of the Governor and the Deputy Governors of the RBI. The majority had held that the Governor General in his discretion should be the appointing authority. Those who subscribed to this view believed that the Governor General would take the Board of the bank into confidence before making such appointments. Even after this condition was inserted it still did not meet with Purshotamdas's approval. He maintained that it was contrary to what had been agreed upon earlier to keep the bank 'free from any political influence' even though the words 'as far as we can make it'[29] had been added later by the Secretary of State.